

FOR PHYSICIANS:

Clinical Overview of Cannabis Suppositories



Introduction

Cannabis suppositories may offer an alternative way to use cannabinoids for those who prefer not to inhale or ingest them. Designed for **rectal or vaginal administration**, they provide a targeted delivery method that some patients report as beneficial for specific conditions.

Potential Pharmacokinetics & Bioavailability

Rectal Administration:

- Some research suggests this route may allow cannabinoids to be absorbed more efficiently than oral ingestion, potentially avoiding first-pass metabolism.
- Depending on individual absorption, this route could offer localized or systemic effects.

Vaginal Administration:

- Primarily thought to have **localized effects**, which may be useful for discomfort related to pelvic issues.
- Systemic absorption appears to be minimal compared to rectal use.

Composition & Suggested Use

Cannabinoid Options:

- CBD-only formulations
- THC-only formulations
- Combination (CBD:THC) formulations

Base Ingredients:

- Commonly include **lipid-based carriers** such as glycerides and fatty acids to support absorption.
- Often free of added terpenes to reduce potential irritation.



Commonly Reported Uses

While individual experiences vary, some people choose cannabis suppositories for:

Rectal Administration:

- Those looking for **digestive support**
- Individuals who report **discomfort related to bowel conditions**
- Some seeking **full-body relaxation**

Vaginal Administration:

- Those exploring options for **menstrual or pelvic discomfort**
- Individuals who describe **challenges with intimacy due to discomfort**
- Some looking for **localized relief**

Considerations for Use

- **Onset time** varies but is often described as **30–45 minutes**.
- **Duration** may range from **4–6 hours**, depending on the individual.
- Some report that **rectal use may lead to more systemic effects** compared to vaginal use.
- **Oil-based formulations are not compatible with latex condoms or barrier methods.**



Patient Guidance

- First-time users may want to **start with a low amount** and gradually adjust as needed.
- Individual responses vary—some may experience **relaxation, while others may feel mild euphoria** with THC-based options.
- If irritation occurs, it is generally recommended to **discontinue use**.
- Keeping a **journal of experiences** can help individuals track their responses.

Summary for Physicians

Cannabis suppositories may be an option for individuals seeking alternative routes of administration. Their targeted absorption and discreet use make them an area of interest for those exploring non-oral cannabis methods. More research is needed to fully understand the differences in bioavailability and effects compared to other delivery methods.





FOR PATIENTS:

A Simple Guide to Cannabis Suppositories

What Are Cannabis Suppositories?

Cannabis suppositories are **small, smooth capsules** designed to be inserted **rectally or vaginally**. Once inserted, they **dissolve and absorb** into the surrounding area.

Why Do People Use Suppositories?

Some individuals choose cannabis suppositories because:

- ✓ They prefer **not to smoke, vape, or take oils**
- ✓ They are looking for **localized relief**
- ✓ They want a **discreet option**



What Are They Commonly Used For?

Rectal Use:

- Some people report using them for **digestive concerns**
- Some seek **relief from general discomfort**
- Others use them for **nausea or relaxation**

Vaginal Use:

- Some individuals explore them for **pelvic discomfort**
- They may be used to **support menstrual or endometriosis-related symptoms**
- Some use them for **intimacy-related reasons**



How Do You Use a Suppository?

For rectal use:

- Empty your bowels if possible.
- Wash your hands.
- Unwrap the suppository.
- **Lie on your side** and gently insert about **1 inch**. (think 1st knuckle)
- Rest for **15 minutes** to allow it to dissolve.

For vaginal use:

- Wash your hands.
- Unwrap the suppository.
- **Lie on your back** or squat for easy insertion.
- Gently insert as **far as comfortable**.
- Rest for **15 minutes** to allow it to dissolve.

FAQs

Will I feel high?

- Some people report mild euphoria with THC-based suppositories, while others say they do not notice psychoactive effects.

Can I use other cannabis products at the same time?

- It's best to approach new products with caution and monitor how they feel before combining them.

How long does it take to work?

- Effects may start in **30–45** minutes and last **4–6 hours**.

Are there side effects?

- Some people experience **mild dizziness or irritation**. If this happens, **consider pausing use**.

Storage & Safety



- **Not for use during pregnancy or breastfeeding.**
- **Store at room temperature below 35°C.**
- **Oil-based suppositories should not be used with condoms.**

Final Thoughts

Cannabis suppositories are an **alternative way** to use cannabinoids that may be worth exploring for those seeking **non-oral, targeted relief**. Since everyone's experience is different, keeping track of how you feel and discussing options with a healthcare professional may be helpful.

